

Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

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### Let's Start!

If life had been different ...



## Learning Outcome

Describe hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

### Ask your partner:

- How would your life have been different if you'd chosen to go to a different school?
- If you hadn't lived in your current house, where would you have lived?

## Can Do Statements

- I can talk about emotions, opinions, behavior and work.
- I can talk about hypothetical situations in the past.
- I can talk about what I wish for in the past, present or future.





## Let's Explore!

Sally wonders how things could have **turned out**\*.

\* To "turn out" means to happen in a particular way.



*Instructions: Read the text aloud.*

Many people wonder how their lives would have turned out if things had been different. For example, one acquaintance of mine wondered, "How could my life have unfolded if I hadn't gone to Paris where I met a famous photographer who unexpectedly snapped a picture of me and changed my career path from teaching to modeling?" Another friend revealed a secret to me. She said that she was having second thoughts about studying medicine. What if her parents hadn't pushed her into that profession? Would she have traveled the world and become a journalist?

If she had the courage to defy her parents and travel, she could have discovered a new passion. The possibilities are endless and in her case there is still time. Using our imagination to see how we might have had an alternate reality helps us to understand the choices we make in the moment. While we might have some regrets, we also realize how fortunate we are when we ask *what if*. If I hadn't started this blog, I wouldn't have connected with so many wonderful people. If I hadn't won the lottery I couldn't have traveled to Europe and changed my outlook on life.

If you hadn't taken an opportunity that you took, you would have been regretful. You would say I wish I had kissed that boy, or, I wish I had tried skydiving, I could tell you what it was like to fly. I wish I hadn't been afraid, I would have succeeded! I wish I had gone on that trip. I should have told him how I felt. I wish I had used my time more wisely. So by learning from our past, we can certainly make our future brighter.





## Let's Practice!

What can you learn from the past?

*Instructions: Choose the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences.*

### Word Bank

wonder / medicine / photographer / regrets / courage / revealed / learning

- Many people \_\_\_\_\_ how their lives would have turned out if things had been different.
- So by \_\_\_\_\_ from our past we can certainly make our future brighter.
- If only she had had the \_\_\_\_\_ to defy her parents and travel.
- While we might have some \_\_\_\_\_, we also realize how fortunate we are when we ask what if.
- Another friend \_\_\_\_\_ a secret to me.
- I met a famous \_\_\_\_\_ who unexpectedly snapped a picture of me and changed my career path.
- She said she was having second thoughts about studying \_\_\_\_\_.



## Let's Practice!

Let's talk about hypothetical situations in the past.

*Instructions: Draw a line to match the sentences in Column A and Column B.*

### COLUMN A

- What if her parents hadn't pushed
- If she had had the courage to
- How could my life have unfolded if I hadn't gone to
- Many people wonder how their lives would
- Would she have traveled the

### COLUMN B

- have turned out if things had been different.
- defy her parents and travel, she could have discovered a new passion.
- her into that profession?
- Paris where I met a famous photographer.
- world and become a journalist?





## Extension Activity

Write a wish list.

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- Talk about the things you wish for in the future and the things you wished for in the past.
- Ask a partner to share his/her wishes for the past and the future.
- Write a dialogue in which you and your partner discuss your wishes for the future.
- Read the dialogue aloud with your partner.

### Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about wishes in the present and past.

☐ ☐

I ask about my partner's wishes in the present and the past.

☐ ☐

I write about wishes in the present and the past.

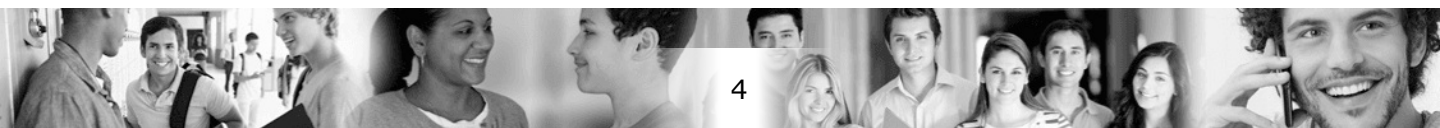
☐ ☐

I read the dialogue with a partner about wishes.

☐ ☐


## Target Words

- **unexpectedly** (adverb): used to describe an action that is surprising because you were not expecting it  
e.g. I met a famous photographer who unexpectedly snapped a picture of me.
- **to snap a picture** (expression): take a photograph  
e.g. That photographer who unexpectedly snapped a picture of me, changed my life.
- **to push someone into** (verb): to persuade or encourage someone to do something that they may not want to do  
e.g. If her parents hadn't pushed her into medicine, she would have been a journalist.
- **to defy** (verb): to refuse to obey a person, decision, law, situation, etc.  
e.g. If she had had the courage to defy her parents and travel, she could have discovered a new passion.
- **alternate** (adjective): if something happens on alternate days, weeks etc., it happens on one day and not the next, and continues in this pattern  
e.g. We might have had an alternate reality.
- **regret** (noun): feeling of wishing you had done something differently in the past  
e.g. We might have some regrets.
- **regretful** (adjective): someone who is regretful feels sorry or disappointed  
e.g. If you hadn't taken an opportunity that you took, you would have been regretful.
- **skydiving** (noun): the sport of jumping from a plane and falling through the sky before opening a parachute  
e.g. I wish I had tried skydiving.
- **wisely** (adverb): with wisdom, knowledge  
e.g. I wish I had used my time more wisely.





## Learning Points

### The Third Conditional - Talking Hypothetically About the Past

The third conditional is used to talk about the past in a hypothetical way. That is, to refer to things that did not happen in the past, but to imagine what might have happened if they had. You can use the third conditional to show regret (things that you wish you had or had not done in the past).

You can use the structures *would have*, *should have* and *could have* with the third conditional to be precise about meaning.

*Could have* (+ past participle) means that something was possible in the past, or you had the ability to do something in the past, but that you didn't do it.

Example: How **could** my life **have unfolded** if I hadn't gone to Paris where I met a famous photographer?

*Should have* (+ past participle) means that you had some obligation to do something in the past, or that it may have been a good idea to do something, however, you did not do it.

*Should have* can express regret about something you did or did not do.

Example: I **should have told** him how I felt. (I regret not telling him how I felt.)

Use *would have* + past participle to talk about a hypothetical situation in the past (something you wanted to do but didn't).

Example: If I had taken that job offer, I **wouldn't have sold** my car.

Remember the structure of the third conditional:

If + subject + had + past participle, subject + could/would/should have + past participle

### Examples:

- What if her parents hadn't pushed her into that profession?
- If she had had the courage to defy her parents and travel, she could have discovered a new passion.
- How could my life have unfolded if I hadn't gone to Paris where I met a famous photographer who unexpectedly snapped a picture of me and changed my career path from teaching to modeling?"
- Many people wonder how their lives would have turned out if things had been different.
- Would she have traveled the world and become a journalist?
- If I hadn't started this blog, I wouldn't have connected with so many wonderful people.
- If you hadn't taken an opportunity that you took, you would have been regretful.
- If I hadn't won the lottery I couldn't have traveled to Europe and changed my outlook on life.





## Learning Points

### Talking about Wishes

When you want to talk about imaginary situations in the past, you can use *wish* plus the past participle of the verb.

When you talk about wishes, you talk about things you wanted that were probably not possible, or for some reason impossible.

You use *wish* + had + past participle to talk about wishes in the past.

For example:

*Sometimes I **wish I had tried** skydiving.*

(I didn't try skydiving.)

#### Examples:

- *You would say I wish I had kissed that boy, or, I wish I had tried skydiving, I could tell you what it was like to fly.*
- *I wish I hadn't been afraid, I would have succeeded!*
- *I wish I had used my time more wisely.*
- *I wish I had gone on that trip.*

